GEC 111 - Understanding the Self

Exam Study Guide: Module Pages 1-44

Covers Lesson 1 (Introduction to Understanding the Self) and the first part of Lesson 2 (The Self from Various Perspectives). Part A is the summary, Part B is 95 situational questions with answers and explanations. Pages 15-18 of the module are worksheets (Activities 1-4) and are only noted, not summarized.

PART A: SUMMARY

LESSON 1: Introduction to Understanding the Self (pp. 3-18)

1. Nature of the Self (pp. 3-5)

- **Self** = one of the most complex notions; **dynamic and ever-changing**; understanding it is a **lifetime process**, not just a semester.
- We show different sides of ourselves depending on who we are with; our **personal identity** (understanding of who you are) influences everything we do.
- **Dr. Paul Thagard (2014):** the Self is a *system of social, psychological, neural and molecular mechanisms*; a product of combined traits, some acquired consciously/voluntarily, others unconsciously/involuntarily.
- **Duality of the Self (William James)** - first American educator to offer a psychology course in the U.S. The self as **'I'** = the subjective **knower**, the processor of information (what we are *becoming*); the self as **'Me'** = the object that is **known**, our thoughts and beliefs about ourselves (who we *are*). (The module also labels these Self-Concept and Self-Awareness, so just remember: *I = knower, Me = known*.)
- **Infants** have a rudimentary/undeveloped self-concept, developing at about **age 2**. **John Locke's Tabula Rasa (blank slate)**: train a child young, because the self-concept gets more complex with age.
- Self-concept evolves from **concrete/observable** traits to **abstract/psychological** traits during childhood and adolescence.
- **Chimps and orangutans** also have a rudimentary self-concept (humans aren't the only species).
- **Self-concept clarity** = extent to which self-knowledge is clearly and consistently defined. **Low clarity** (Campbell et al., 1996): more neurotic, low self-esteem, less aware of internal states.

Three adaptive functions of the self

Function	What it does
Managerial	Informs us of our relationship to the physical and social world, organizes behavior, helps plan for the future
Organizational	Acts as a schema that helps us interpret and recall information about ourselves and the social world
Emotional	Helps determine our emotional responses

2. Elements of the Self: Carl Rogers's Self Theory (pp. 5-7)

Self Theory emphasizes the set of perceptions an individual has of himself and of his relationships with others and other aspects of life. It has **four elements**:

Element	Meaning	Example / key idea
Self-image	Set of beliefs about yourself; how you see yourself based on strengths and weaknesses; built on *perception* of reality, influenced by how you think others view you	Erik Erikson: identity forms through lifelong, usually unconscious development, per social circumstances
Ideal self	The way you would like to be; an idealized image built from what parents taught, who we admire, what society promotes, what we think is in our best interest	Gap can exist between ideal self and self-image
Looking-glass self	Your perception of how *others* perceive you (perception of others' perception)	Seen as happy-go-lucky, but you prefer being alone at home
Real self	Who we actually are: how we think, feel, look, act. Self-image is confirmed when others respond and share their beliefs (feedback)	Feedback helps adjust self-image

Healthy vs. unhealthy self-image

Healthy self-image	Unhealthy self-image
Based on own personal feelings and perspectives	Heavily influenced by other people's opinions
Not shaped by others' opinions or societal expectations	Defined by societal standards, norms and expectations
Optimistic outlook, confidence in own ability	Consistently focuses on flaws and limitations
Built on a high level of self-worth	Persistently criticizes self, judges most decisions and actions

3. Self-Esteem (pp. 7-10)

- **Self-esteem** = a person's overall sense of **self-worth or personal value**; how much you appreciate and like yourself. Often seen as a **personality trait** (stable, enduring). Closely related to personal/self-identity (values, goals, traits, perceptions unique to a person).
- **Why important:** affects motivation and success. Low self-esteem holds you back (you don't believe you can succeed); healthy self-esteem = positive, assertive attitude.
- Distinct from **self-efficacy**: belief in how well you will handle *future* actions, performance or abilities.
- **Factors that influence self-esteem:** genetics (personality), but mostly **experiences**; overly critical assessments from caregivers, family, friends; inner thinking; age; illness, disability or physical limitations; job.

Maslow's Hierarchy of Needs - five-tier motivational theory; lower needs must be satisfied before higher ones. From the bottom: **(1) Physiological, (2) Safety, (3) Love and belonging, (4) Esteem, (5) Self-actualization.** Esteem includes esteem from others AND inner self-respect; both are needed to grow and reach self-actualization.

Signs of healthy self-esteem	Signs of low self-esteem
Confidence	Lack of confidence
Ability to say no	Belief that others are better than you
Positive outlook	Trouble accepting positive feedback; negative outlook
Sees and accepts strengths and weaknesses	Focus on your weaknesses
Negative experiences don't change overall perspective	Excessive shame, depression or anxiety; intense fear of failure

Signs of healthy self-esteem	Signs of low self-esteem
Ability to express needs	Inability to express needs

4. Self-Awareness (pp. 10-14)

Self-awareness = ability to focus on yourself and how your actions, thoughts or emotions do or don't align with your **internal standards**. Highly self-aware people can evaluate themselves objectively, manage emotions, align behavior with values and understand how others see them. **Three routes:** introspection, observation of one's own behavior, self-schemas.

A. Introspection

- **Introspection** = looking inward to examine your own thoughts, feelings and motives. People don't introspect as much as expected and may not understand the reasons for their thoughts and behavior.
- **Self-awareness theory:** when we focus on ourselves we compare behavior to internal standards/values; can lead to positive or negative results. We also assume we are more **transparent** to others than we are (especially in collectivist cultures); research (Vorauer & Ross, 1999) shows this does not hold.
- **Negative:** painful, may cause anxiety and anger when we fall short of standards (e.g., presenting yourself as honest but sometimes cheating and lying creates confusion). People then avoid the thought by **distraction** (TV, reading) or **escape** (drinking; in the extreme, suicide).
- **Positive:** satisfaction on achieving a life goal (university degree) or major success (Olympic gold).
- **Rumination** = involuntary, neurotic self-focus tied to threat/uncertainty; dredges up memories matching a bad mood (failures, unhappy times); cannot cheer self up. **Reflection** = emotionally positive self-focus with openness and intellectual curiosity about the self; develops strategies to relieve negative feelings (e.g., recalling positive events).

B. Observation of one's own behavior: Self-Perception Theory

- **Bem's (1972) self-perception theory:** we find out how we feel by observing what we do. When attitudes/feelings are **uncertain or ambiguous**, we infer them from our behavior and the situation. We do this **only when unsure**.
- **Intrinsic motivation** = engaging because we enjoy it or find it interesting. **Extrinsic motivation** = engaging because of external rewards or pressures. Intrinsically motivated people enjoy activities more and **persist** longer (sports, academics, politics, relationships).
- **Over-justification effect:** giving extrinsic rewards for something already intrinsically enjoyed replaces intrinsic motivation, so people lose interest; they underestimate how much their behavior was caused by intrinsic reasons.

C. Self-Schemas

- **Self-schemas** = organized knowledge structures about ourselves, based on past experience; help us **understand, explain and predict** our behavior, interpret new events, and organize our past (autobiographical memories).
- Memories are **reconstructive**: we view the past in ways consistent with current theories and schemas (Ross et al., Waterloo studies).
- Wanting to see ourselves positively affects which memories we recall (Kunda & Fong, 1990); we recall desirable traits more than undesirable ones. The way a question is asked influences which memories we access (Kunda et al., 1993), e.g., asked if happy, we talk about what makes us happy.

- Schemas can be wrong and distort memory: attitudes may change, but if our schema says they haven't, we **underestimate** the change.

Pp. 15-18: Assessment worksheets (Activity 1 'Let's get to know you', Activity 2 four elements of self, Activity 3 Maslow pyramid plus 5 intrinsic and 5 extrinsic motivations, Activity 4 famous person strengths/weaknesses). These are personal reflections with no memorizable content.

LESSON 2: The Self from Various Perspectives (pp. 19-44)

Lesson outcomes: identify concepts/theories of the self from philosophical, psychological and Eastern vs. Western perspectives; compare how the self is presented across disciplines; think critically about one's own self-development.

1. Philosophical Perspectives (pp. 19-25)

- Philosophy = **'mother of all disciplines'** (all fields began as philosophical discourse). The **Greeks** questioned myths to understand reality. The self is defined as 'a unified being, essentially connected to consciousness, awareness and agency (or at least the faculty of rational choice).'
- **Empiricism**: no innate knowledge; knowledge comes from **experience**; self explained by sensory and bodily responses. **Rationalism**: there is innate knowledge; explains self by what is 'ideal' and 'truth', through **logic and reasoning**, not senses/body.

Philosopher	Key ideas on the self
Socrates	'**Know thyself**'; first to systematically question the self; never wrote his ideas, discussed them with students. Real self = **psyche/soul**, not body. Self has two parts: physical (mortal, constantly changing) and soul (**immortal**, unchanging, goes to the ideal realm at death). 'A life unexamined is not worth living.' Core ethic: **virtue and knowledge**; virtue is innate and can be learned; wrongdoing comes from ignorance; self-knowledge is the source of wisdom; one becomes master of oneself through knowledge. 'To live but die inside' is the worst thing.
Plato	Student of Socrates. True self = reason/intellect of the soul, separable from the body. **Three-part soul: Rational** (reason, intellect), **Spirited** (emotions), **Appetitive** (basic desires: eating, drinking, sex). Man was all-knowing before birth, 'exiled' on earth and forgetful; regains perfection through remembering, contemplation and doing good; should imitate his divine exemplar (perfect self); happiness is the fruit of virtue.
Aristotle	Human is a **composite of body and soul**; soul cannot be separated from the body. **Hylomorphism:** soul = the form/functional organization of the body (growth, nutrition, reproduction, perception, imagination, desire, thinking).
Immanuel Kant	**Respect for self.** Man governs himself, sets own ends, freely chooses means. **Every man is an end in himself**, never merely a means/tool; respect others as yourself; all persons have the same basic rights. Source of the idea of human rights.
Rene Descartes	'Father of modern philosophy'. **Dualism** (body and mind). Only thing that can't be doubted is the existence of the self as a thinking thing: '**I think, therefore I am**' (*Cogito ergo sum*). Two entities: **Cogito** (mind, the thing that thinks) and the **extension** of the mind (body; the module spells it 'Extenza'). Mind and body are independent but man must use his mind to investigate and develop himself. Self independent of social status, upbringing, gender, race.
John Locke	**Personal identity** = **psychological continuity**, found in consciousness (**memory**), not soul or body. Evolves over life; includes things out of our control (where we grew up, skin color) and choices (how we spend time, beliefs). Also: Tabula Rasa.
David Hume	**Bundle theory of mind.** Skeptical of a simple, unified self that exists over time. No 'clear and intelligible' idea of self. The self is 'a bundle or collection of different perceptions which succeed each other with an inconceivable rapidity'; impressions would have to stay constant to make identity.

Philosophy and the Self (pp. 24-25): Three types of views: (1) Aristotelian/homo economicus line and Kant's autonomous self (independence from social and biological surroundings); (2) the view of the self as biologically developing in a specific environment. Descartes (17th c.) put the self at the center of Western tradition: thinking is independent of environment, so social status, upbringing, gender, race are extraneous. Kant developed this: every individual can imagine courses of action beyond emotional state, race, customs, status; this underlies **human rights**. **Homo economicus**: every person is an individual agent whose sole

motive for action is **self-interest**. **Conclusion:** the self is a **development process in a specific environmental space**; factors like social status, sex, education, gender, upbringing, emotional history and race shape it; the self is **dynamic, continuously in the making**.

2. Psychological Perspectives (pp. 25-38)

There's no single 'right' way to study behavior; different schools (approaches/perspectives) emphasize different factors (e.g., genetics vs. early childhood).

A. Psychodynamic

- Studies psychological forces underlying behavior, feelings and emotions, tied to **early childhood experience**; focuses on **conscious vs. unconscious** motivation; behavior is the product of underlying conflicts people are often unaware of.
- Born **1874**: **Ernst von Brucke** (organisms are energy systems; conservation of energy); medical student **Sigmund Freud** expanded it: psychological processes are flows of psychosexual energy (**libido**); Freud coined **'psychoanalysis'**. Later developed by Carl Jung, Alfred Adler, Melanie Klein. Josef Breuer and Anna O. case = start of psychoanalysis. Established by mid-1940s to 1950s.

Freud's structural model	Description
Id	Unconscious; cauldron of raw drives (sex, aggression)
Ego	Conscious and unconscious; rational, reasonable; keeps contact with the outside world; **mediates** between id and superego
Superego	Conscience; develops early, learned from parents, teachers, others; conscious and unconscious elements

When id, ego, superego are in dynamic equilibrium = mentally healthy. If the ego can't mediate = imbalance = **psychological distress**.

Psychosexual stages: oral, anal, phallic, latency, genital (five). Pleasure-seeking focuses on a different **erogenous zone** at each stage. Lacking proper nurturing = **fixation**. Today disputed as a legitimate explanation, but the takeaway: childhood experiences shape personality. Psychodynamic therapy (becoming aware of dynamic conflicts) is still commonly used.

B. Behavioral

- Emerged early 20th century as a **reaction to psychoanalysis** (hard to test). Focuses on **observable, overt behavior learned from the environment**, not thoughts or underlying conflicts. Application: **behavior modification**. Learning = behavior change through classical or operant conditioning. Key figures: Pavlov, Watson, Thorndike, Skinner.

Psychologist	Contribution
Ivan Pavlov (Russian)	**Classical conditioning**: 1890s dog experiment, bell paired with food until dogs salivated to the bell; automatic form of learning
John B. Watson	**Little Albert**: 9-month-old taught to fear a white toy rat by pairing it with a loud noise; emotions can be conditioned responses
Edward Thorndike	**Law of effect**: satisfying responses are more likely to recur; discomforting ones less likely

Psychologist	Contribution
B. F. Skinner	**Operant conditioning**: voluntary response strengthened or weakened by consequences. **Positive reinforcement** = adding a positive consequence (food, attention); **negative reinforcement** = removing a negative consequence (pain, loud noise). Behavior shaped by trial and error through reinforcement and punishment; disorders are maladaptive learned behaviors that can be unlearned. Not reinforcing a behavior can **extinguish** it. 'Triple contingency' (environment, behavior, mind) led to **applied behavior analysis (ABA)**, used for children on the autism spectrum but controversial.

C. Cognitive

- Examines **internal mental processes**: problem solving, memory, language. **Cognition** = thinking and memory processes; **cognitive development** = long-term changes in them.
- Different from earlier approaches because it (1) accepts the **scientific method** and generally **rejects introspection** (unlike Freudian psychoanalysis) and (2) **acknowledges internal mental states** like belief, desire, motivation (unlike behaviorism). Solutions take the form of algorithms, heuristics or insights. Areas: perception, memory, categorization, knowledge representation, numerical cognition, language, thinking.
- **Roots: Donald Broadbent (1958)**, *Perception and Communication*, information-processing model; **Ulric Neisser (1967)** coined 'cognitive psychology'; foundations in **Gestalt psychology** (Wertheimer, Kohler, Koffka) and **Jean Piaget**; **Noam Chomsky** (American linguist) was dissatisfied with behaviorism and influential in the cognitive revolution.
- **Jean Piaget:** stage theory of **cognitive development**; how children become able to think logically and scientifically; each new stage is a distinct shift in thinking and reasoning (the module does not list the stages in pp. 1-44).

D. Humanistic

- Rose mid-20th century; draws on existentialism, phenomenology and Eastern philosophy; **holistic**; focuses on meaning, values, freedom, personal responsibility, human potential, spirituality, **self-actualization**. Attributes behavior to **free will** and an innate drive for self-actualization; people are **inherently good**; emphasizes max potential rather than disorders. Criticized for **subjectivity and lack of evidence**.
- **Abraham Maslow** (1908-1970): founder of humanistic psychology; hierarchy of needs; studied **mentally healthy** individuals; coined **'peak experiences'** (high points of harmony with self and surroundings).
- **Carl Rogers** (1902-1987): **person-centered therapy**, non-directive, present-focused; therapist uses **active listening and mirroring**; **unconditional positive regard** = accepting a person entirely with no negative judgment of worth. Raised with unconditional regard = can fully actualize; raised with **conditional positive regard** = feel worthy only if they meet others' conditions.
- **Rollo May** (1909-1994): best-known American **existential** psychologist; sharper awareness of the **tragic dimensions** of existence; emphasized human **choice**.

E. Biological (Biopsychology)

- Applies principles of biology to mental processes and behavior (subfields: behavioral neuroscience, cognitive neuroscience, neuropsychology). Because all behavior is controlled by the **central nervous system**, understanding the brain explains behavior. Focus: sensation/perception, motivated behavior (hunger, thirst, sex), movement, learning and memory, sleep and rhythms, emotion; now language, reasoning, decision-making, consciousness.

- **History:** Descartes proposed the **pineal gland** as the point of contact between mind and body; **William James**, *Principles of Psychology* (1890): psychology should be grounded in biology; **Knight Dunlap (1914)** first used 'psychobiology' in its modern sense (*An Outline of Psychobiology*).

3. Eastern vs. Western / Socio-Cultural Perspectives (pp. 39-44)

- **East** = Asian cultures (Chinese, Japanese, Korean, Indian and **Filipino**; we are Easterners). **West** = Europe and Northern America (Americans, British, Germans, Italians, French).
- **Sociocultural factors:** large-scale forces in cultures and societies (attitudes, childrearing, prejudice, ethnic/racial identity, gender roles, family and kinship, power, region, religion, rituals, taboos). Subfields: social, cultural, cultural-historical psychology.
- **Cultural psychology:** psychological tendencies are rooted in culture; **mind and culture are inseparable and mutually constitutive**. Goal: broaden the variety of cultures in basic theories. Research overrepresents **Western, educated, industrialized** populations yet labels findings 'universal'. **Cross-cultural** psychology uses culture to test **universality**; **cultural** psychology studies how local practices **shape** psychological processes (e.g., test whether Piaget's stages are universal vs. how social practices shape cognition differently).

Aspect (Yang Liu posters)	Western	Eastern (incl. Filipinos)
Concept of self	Huge and important	Tendency to look down on oneself
Dealing with problems	Face the problem directly	Ignore or 'tiptoe around' it to avoid trouble
Anger	Not afraid to show anger	Expected to keep smiling even when angry or frustrated
Expressing opinions	Direct, to the point	Roundabout ('paikot-ikot')

Artist **Yang Liu** (Chinese family, grew up in Germany) made posters: blue side = typical Western behavior, red side = typical Eastern behavior.

- **Lev Vygotsky - cultural-historical psychology** (late 1920s): culture's values, beliefs, customs and skills are **transmitted across generations** through **social interaction**, especially with knowledgeable community/family members; development differs between cultures so children become competent in tasks valued by their society.
- **Social psychology:** scientific study of how thoughts, feelings and behaviors are influenced by the **actual, imagined or implied presence of others**. Explains behavior as the interaction of mental states and immediate social situations; people change behavior to fit the situation and take cues from others when unsure. Levels: **intrapersonal** (emotions, attitudes) and **interpersonal** (aggression, attraction). Cognitive biases studied: **fundamental attribution error, actor-observer bias, self-serving bias, just-world hypothesis**.
- **History:** began in the U.S. in the early 20th century; first study: **Norman Triplett (1898)**, **social facilitation**; **Kurt Lewin** (Gestalt) in the 1930s helped make it separate from behavioral and psychoanalytic schools; WWII studies of persuasion and propaganda; postwar interest in gender issues, racial prejudice, cognitive dissonance, bystander intervention, aggression, obedience to authority. Sociologists focus more on macro-level variables (social structure).

Erik Erikson's Psychosocial Development - an ego psychologist influenced by Freud, but focused on **psychosocial** (not psychosexual) development.

Age	Crisis / task	Virtue
Infant - 18 months	Trust vs. Mistrust	Hope

Age	Crisis / task	Virtue
18 months - 3 years	Autonomy vs. Shame/Doubt	Will
3 - 5 years	Initiative vs. Guilt	Purpose
5 - 13 years	Industry vs. Inferiority	Competence
13 - 21 years	Identity vs. Confusion	Fidelity
21 - 39 years	Intimacy vs. Isolation	Love
40 - 65 years	Generativity vs. Stagnation	Care
65 and older	Integrity vs. Despair	Wisdom

Quick Review: Who Said What

Name	Remember
William James	Duality of the self (I / Me); 1890 Principles of Psychology
Thagard	Self = system of social, psychological, neural, molecular mechanisms
Locke	Tabula rasa; personal identity = memory/consciousness
Carl Rogers	Self theory (4 elements); person-centered; unconditional positive regard
Erik Erikson	Identity formed lifelong; 8 psychosocial stages
Maslow	Hierarchy of needs; peak experiences
Bem	Self-perception theory
Socrates / Plato / Aristotle	Know thyself, soul immortal / three-part soul / hylomorphism
Descartes / Kant / Hume	Cogito ergo sum, dualism / every person an end / bundle theory
Freud	Psychoanalysis; id-ego-superego; 5 psychosexual stages
Pavlov / Watson / Thorndike / Skinner	Classical conditioning / Little Albert / law of effect / operant conditioning
Broadbent / Neisser / Chomsky / Piaget	Info-processing (1958) / coined 'cognitive psychology' (1967) / cognitive revolution / cognitive development stages
Rollo May	Existential; choice; tragic dimension
Vygotsky	Cultural-historical psychology
Triplett / Lewin	Social facilitation (1898) / social psychology as separate field

PART B: SITUATIONAL QUESTIONS (Items 1-60)

Directions: Choose the best answer. The correct answer and the reason are shown under each item, so cover them with paper while practicing.

1. Maria looks at herself and describes what she knows about her own traits: 'I am a student, a sister, and a basketball player.' According to William James, which part of the self is she describing?

A. The 'I', the subjective knower
B. The 'Me', the object that is known
C. The id
D. The superego

Answer: B. In James's duality of the self, the 'Me' is the known: our thoughts and beliefs about ourselves. The 'I' is the knower, the processor of information.

2. Jun constantly observes, evaluates and processes information about how he is changing and what he is becoming. Which side of the self is Jun using?

A. The 'Me', the known
B. The ideal self
C. The 'I', the knower
D. The looking-glass self

Answer: C. The knower (the 'I') is the processor of information, 'what we are becoming'. This split is the Duality of the Self (William James).

3. A teacher explains that a person can be a son, a friend and a professional at once, and that these identities change as life goes on. Which characteristic of the self does this show?

A. The self is static
B. The self is dynamic and ever-changing
C. The self is fixed at birth
D. The self is only the physical body

Answer: B. The module stresses that the self is dynamic: it changes and evolves over time, and understanding it is a lifelong process.

4. A student says, 'The self is only my soul, nothing else.' Which statement best matches Dr. Paul Thagard's (2014) definition?

A. The self is a bundle of perceptions
B. The self is the immortal soul
C. The self is a system of social, psychological, neural and molecular mechanisms
D. The self is the id, ego and superego

Answer: C. Thagard defines the self as a system of social, psychological, neural and molecular mechanisms, a product of many combined traits, some acquired consciously and some unconsciously.

5. A 6-month-old baby is placed in front of a mirror and shows no clear awareness of 'who' she is. What does the module say about this?

A. Infants already have a fully developed self-concept
B. Infants have a rudimentary or undeveloped self-concept, which develops at about age 2
C. Self-concept only begins at adolescence
D. Infants have no potential for a self-concept

Answer: B. Human infants have a rudimentary self-concept, which develops at about age 2 years.

6. A father insists on teaching good habits to his child very early because 'a young mind is like a blank slate.' Whose idea is this?

A. John Locke (Tabula Rasa)
B. Sigmund Freud
C. Rene Descartes
D. Carl Rogers

Answer: A. Tabula Rasa (blank slate) is John Locke's idea: the best time to train a child is at a young age, since the self-concept becomes more complex as we grow older.

7. At age 6 Lia says, 'I have long hair and I like dolls.' At age 16 she says, 'I am loyal, kind and ambitious.' What does this show about self-concept development?

A. Self-concept never changes
B. It moves from abstract to concrete
C. It is controlled only by genetics
D. It moves from concrete, observable traits to abstract, psychological traits

Answer: D. Over childhood and adolescence, the self-concept evolves from concrete and observable characteristics to abstract psychological ones.

8. A researcher observes that a chimpanzee recognizes itself in a mirror. What does the module conclude?

A. Only humans have a sense of self
B. Chimps and orangutans also have a rudimentary self-concept
C. Animals have a more complex self than humans
D. Animals have a self-schema but no self-concept

Answer: B. The module states that humans are not the only species with a sense of self; chimps and orangutans have a rudimentary self-concept.

9. Rina describes herself differently every day, has low self-esteem, is often anxious and does not notice her own inner states. According to Campbell et al. (1996), what is she likely low in?

A. Self-concept clarity
B. Self-efficacy
C. Intrinsic motivation
D. Conscience

Answer: A. Self-concept clarity is how clearly and consistently self-knowledge is defined. Low clarity goes with being more neurotic, having low self-esteem and being less aware of internal states.

10. Carlo uses his understanding of who he is to plan his career and organize his daily behavior. Which function of the self is this?

A. Emotional function
B. Organizational function
C. Managerial function
D. Defensive function

Answer: C. The managerial function informs us of our relationship to the physical and social world, organizes our behavior and helps us plan for the future.

11. Because Nina sees herself as 'a responsible person', she easily remembers and interprets events that match this view. Which function of the self is at work?

A. Managerial function
B. Emotional function
C. Organizational function
D. Biological function

Answer: C. The organizational function means the self acts as a schema that helps us interpret and recall information about ourselves and the social world.

12. Whether Tony feels proud or ashamed in a situation depends on how he sees himself. Which function of the self is this?

A. Emotional function
B. Managerial function
C. Organizational function
D. Social function

Answer: A. The emotional function of the self helps determine our emotional responses.

13. A counselor applying Carl Rogers's Self Theory lists the elements of the self. Which item does NOT belong on her list?

A. Self-image
B. Ideal self
C. Superego
D. Looking-glass self

Answer: C. Rogers's four elements are self-image, ideal self, looking-glass self and real self. The superego belongs to Freud's structural model.

14. Pedro believes he is clumsy and weak in math because he focuses on what he thinks are his strengths and weaknesses. Which element of the self is this?

A. Self-image
B. Ideal self
C. Real self
D. Id

Answer: A. Self-image is the set of beliefs about yourself: your impression of your own assets and liabilities, built on your perception of reality.

15. Ana wants to be a confident public speaker, but she sees herself as nervous and shy. What does this gap represent?

A. Gap between id and ego
B. Over-justification effect
C. Gap between rumination and reflection
D. Gap between the ideal self and the self-image

Answer: D. The ideal self is who you would like to be; the self-image is the reality you perceive. There can be a gap between them.

16. Lito acts cheerful at work, so coworkers think he is happy-go-lucky, but he actually prefers being alone at home. When Lito believes 'they see me as a party person', which concept applies?

A. Real self
B. Looking-glass self
C. Ideal self
D. Self-efficacy

Answer: B. The looking-glass self is the perception of other people's perception of you, not who you actually are.

17. Friends tell Carla she is truly generous, and this matches what she already thinks of herself. In the module's terms, what has happened?

A. Her ideal self has changed
B. She is experiencing the over-justification effect
C. Her self-image has been confirmed by others' feedback (real self)
D. She is ruminating

Answer: C. The real self is who we actually are. A self-image is confirmed when others respond and share their beliefs, which is feedback that helps adjust the self-image.

18. According to Erik Erikson, how is identity formed?

A. Through lifelong development, usually unconscious to the individual and society
B. Quickly, in early childhood only
C. Only by conscious choice
D. Only by genetics

Answer: A. Erikson said identity is formed through a lifelong, usually unconscious development, shaped by social circumstances.

19. Which person has a HEALTHY self-image?

A. Dan, who bases his view of himself on society's standards
B. Eli, who bases it on his own feelings and perspectives, is optimistic and not swayed by others' opinions
C. Fay, who persistently criticizes her decisions
D. Gil, who focuses on his flaws

Answer: B. A healthy self-image rests on the person's own feelings, is not driven by others' opinions or societal expectations, and comes with optimism and high self-worth.

20. Hana constantly criticizes herself, judges most of her decisions, and her view of herself depends heavily on what other people say. What does she show?

A. Healthy self-image
B. High self-efficacy
C. Unhealthy self-image
D. Self-actualization

Answer: C. An unhealthy self-image focuses on flaws, is heavily influenced by others' opinions, involves persistent self-criticism, and is defined by societal standards.

21. Joy wants to become a doctor because of what her parents taught her, an aunt she admires, and what society values. Which element of the self is being described?

A. Real self
B. Looking-glass self
C. Ideal self
D. Self-image

Answer: C. The ideal self is built over time from what parents taught us, what we admire in others, what society promotes, and what we think is in our best interest.

22. A classmate asks what 'self-esteem' means in psychology. Which is the best answer?

A. The belief that you can handle future tasks
B. The ability to read others' thoughts
C. A person's overall sense of self-worth or personal value
D. The unconscious drives of the id

Answer: C. Self-esteem is a person's overall sense of self-worth or personal value, how much you appreciate and like yourself.

23. Why is self-esteem often described as a personality trait?

A. It tends to be stable and enduring
B. It changes hourly
C. It is only found in adults
D. It is inherited through the genes alone

Answer: A. The module notes self-esteem is often seen as a personality trait, meaning it tends to be stable and enduring.

24. Mark does not try out for the basketball team because he doesn't believe he can succeed. Which concept best explains this?

A. Healthy self-esteem
B. Low self-esteem holding him back
C. Extrinsic motivation
D. Self-actualization

Answer: B. Low self-esteem can hold people back at school or work because they don't believe they are capable of success.

25. Which is the correct order of Maslow's hierarchy from the bottom upward?

A. Safety, physiological, love and belonging, esteem, self-actualization
B. Physiological, love and belonging, safety, esteem, self-actualization
C. Physiological, safety, love and belonging, esteem, self-actualization
D. Esteem, safety, physiological, belonging, self-actualization

Answer: C. From bottom to top: physiological, safety, love and belonging, esteem, self-actualization.

26. A student is very hungry and sleep-deprived and cannot focus on earning recognition. Using Maslow's theory, why?

A. Esteem needs are always first
B. Self-actualization comes before basic needs
C. Lower needs must be satisfied before higher needs can be attended to
D. Needs are all equal in priority

Answer: C. In Maslow's model, needs lower in the hierarchy (physiological) must be met before individuals can attend to higher ones.

27. Sam has food, safety and loving friends, but now wants respect from others and inner self-respect. Which level is he at?

A. Safety
B. Love and belonging
C. Physiological
D. Esteem

Answer: D. Esteem needs involve esteem from other people and inner self-respect. Both must be fulfilled for a person to reach self-actualization.

28. Before her report, Ella says, 'I believe I can handle this presentation well.' Which concept is this?

A. Self-efficacy
B. Self-esteem
C. Self-schema
D. Looking-glass self

Answer: A. Self-efficacy is the belief about how well you will handle future actions, performance or abilities. It is distinct from self-esteem, which is overall self-worth.

29. A child is constantly given overly critical, negative comments by caregivers and friends. What is the likely effect?

A. High self-esteem
B. Better self-efficacy
C. Problems with low self-esteem
D. No effect, because only genes matter

Answer: C. Experiences, such as consistently critical assessments from caregivers, family and friends, are a major basis for self-esteem, so this child will likely develop low self-esteem.

30. Which behavior is a sign of HEALTHY self-esteem?

A. Trouble accepting compliments
B. Ability to say no and express your needs
C. Intense fear of failure
D. Believing others are better than you

Answer: B. Signs of healthy self-esteem include confidence, the ability to say no, a positive outlook, accepting strengths and weaknesses, and expressing needs.

31. Which of the following is a sign of LOW self-esteem?

A. Positive outlook
B. Belief that others are better than you and focus on weaknesses
C. Ability to express needs
D. Negative experiences don't change overall perspective

Answer: B. Low self-esteem shows as lack of confidence, belief that others are better, trouble accepting positive feedback, negative outlook, focus on weaknesses, and intense fear of failure.

32. Which statement best defines self-awareness?

A. Ability to control other people's thoughts
B. Learning through rewards and punishment
C. A set of perceptions of relationships with others
D. Ability to focus on yourself and see how your actions, thoughts or emotions align with your internal standards

Answer: D. Self-awareness is the ability to focus on yourself and how your actions, thoughts or emotions do or don't align with your internal standards.

33. A teacher lists ways to gain self-awareness. Which one is NOT among the module's three?

A. Introspection
B. Operant conditioning
C. Observation of one's own behavior
D. Self-schemas

Answer: B. The module's three routes are introspection, observation of one's own behavior (self-perception theory) and self-schemas.

34. Lea sits quietly and examines her own thoughts, feelings and motives about a quarrel. What is she doing?

A. Over-justification
B. Classical conditioning
C. Projection
D. Introspection

Answer: D. Introspection is the process of looking inward and examining your own thoughts, feelings and motives.

35. Rico presents himself as honest, yet he sometimes cheats. When he notices this, he feels anxious and confused. What explains this?

A. Over-justification effect
B. Self-awareness theory: comparing behavior to internal standards revealed a discrepancy
C. Law of effect
D. Unconditional positive regard

Answer: B. Self-awareness theory says that when we focus on ourselves we compare our behavior to our internal standards. A discrepancy can produce negative feelings such as anxiety and confusion.

36. After realizing he does not live up to his own values, Ben binge-watches TV to stop thinking about it. What does this illustrate?

A. Reflection
B. Avoiding painful self-awareness through distraction
C. Intrinsic motivation
D. Self-efficacy

Answer: B. People who find a discrepancy too hard to deal with often avoid the thought by distracting themselves (TV, reading) or escaping (e.g., drinking).

37. Which situation is an example of POSITIVE results of introspection?

A. Feeling satisfied after earning a university degree
B. Feeling anxious after cheating
C. Feeling angry after failing
D. Replaying failures again and again

Answer: A. Introspection can bring positive thoughts and feelings, such as satisfaction at achieving a life goal like a degree or a major success.

38. After failing an exam, Tess keeps recalling past failures and unhappy times and cannot cheer herself up. What is she doing?

A. Reflection
B. Introspection of positive events
C. Rumination
D. Self-perception

Answer: C. Rumination is an involuntary, neurotic form of self-focus tied to threat or uncertainty. People dredge up memories that match their bad mood.

39. After failing, Mia explores her feelings with curiosity and cheers herself up by remembering good times. What is this?

A. Reflection
B. Rumination
C. Over-justification
D. Extrinsic motivation

Answer: A. Reflection is an emotionally positive form of self-focus with openness to self-exploration and intellectual curiosity. People develop strategies to alleviate negative feelings.

40. Tom is sure everyone can see how nervous he is at the front of the class, but classmates barely notice. What does research (Vorauer & Ross, 1999) say about this?

A. We are always fully transparent to others
B. Others read us better than we read ourselves
C. Only collectivists are transparent
D. The assumed transparency does not hold: others cannot read us as easily as we think

Answer: D. We tend to think we are more transparent to others than we are, especially in collectivist cultures, but research shows this assumption does not hold.

41. Ella isn't sure whether she likes jogging. She notices she jogs every morning without being forced and concludes, 'I must enjoy it.' Which theory is this?

A. Self-awareness theory
B. Self-perception theory (Bem)
C. Psychosexual theory
D. Looking-glass theory

Answer: B. Bem's self-perception theory says that when attitudes are uncertain, we infer them by observing our own behavior and the situation it occurs in.

42. Pia plays guitar for hours simply because she enjoys it and finds it interesting. What type of motivation is this?

A. Extrinsic motivation
B. Conditional regard
C. Negative reinforcement
D. Intrinsic motivation

Answer: D. Intrinsic motivation is the desire to engage in an activity because we enjoy it or find it interesting.

43. Ken studies only to get a gift from his parents and to avoid being scolded. What type of motivation is this?

A. Intrinsic motivation
B. Self-actualization
C. Peak experience
D. Extrinsic motivation

Answer: D. Extrinsic motivation is the desire to engage in an activity because of external rewards or pressures.

44. A child loves drawing. A relative begins paying her for every drawing, and soon she loses interest in drawing. What is this called?

A. Over-justification effect
B. Law of effect
C. Tabula rasa
D. Self-serving bias

Answer: A. When extrinsic rewards replace intrinsic motivation for something already enjoyed, people attribute their behavior to the reward and lose interest.

45. Nico thinks 'I'm a hardworking person'. This organized knowledge about himself helps him interpret new events and recall his past. What is this?

A. Id
B. Self-schema
C. Tabula rasa
D. Introspection

Answer: B. Self-schemas are organized knowledge structures about ourselves, based on past experience, that help us understand, explain and predict our own behavior.

46. When asked 'Are you happy?', Rosa talks only about the things that make her happy. What does this show about self-schemas and memory?

A. The way questions are asked and our wish to see ourselves positively influence which memories we recall
B. Memory is never influenced
C. We only remember unpleasant traits
D. Memory is always accurate

Answer: A. Motivational factors and the way we are asked questions affect which self-memories we access. We more readily recall desirable traits than undesirable ones.

47. Years ago, Ben changed his opinion about a social issue, but his self-schema says his views have not changed. What is the result?

A. He accurately reports the change
B. He overestimates the change
C. He loses all his memories
D. He underestimates the amount of change that occurred

Answer: D. Self-schemas can distort memory. Because our schema says our attitudes did not change, we underestimate the amount of change that occurs.

48. Why is philosophy called the 'mother of all disciplines'?

A. Because it is the newest discipline
B. Because it rejects questions
C. Because it only studies the self
D. Because all fields of study began as philosophical discourse

Answer: D. All fields of study began as philosophical discourses. The Greeks questioned myths and sought to understand reality, including the question of the self.

49. Which Greek aphorism did Socrates use as his guiding principle?

A. I think, therefore I am
B. Man is the measure of all things
C. The unexamined self is a bundle
D. Know thyself

Answer: D. The ancient aphorism 'Know thyself' was Socrates's guiding principle, which he passed on to his students through endless discussions.

50. According to Socrates, when a person dies, what travels to the ideal realm?

A. The soul, which is immortal
B. The body
C. The Earth
D. Nothing; the self ends

Answer: A. Socrates held that the real self is the psyche (soul). The body is mortal and stays in the physical realm, while the soul is immortal and unchanging.

51. A man says, 'A life unexamined is not worth living.' Which philosopher's idea is this?

A. Hume
B. Kant
C. Socrates
D. Locke

Answer: C. This is Socrates, the first philosopher to engage in systematic questioning about the self, who emphasized that the true task of the philosopher is to know oneself.

52. A man steals because he honestly does not know what is truly good. Which Socratic idea explains this?

A. Humans are naturally evil
B. Virtue cannot be learned
C. The body decides morality
D. Bad actions come from ignorance: one who does not follow the good fails to recognize it

Answer: D. For Socrates, a bad man is not virtuous through ignorance. The core Socratic ethic links virtue and knowledge: self-knowledge is the source of wisdom.

53. Dino is overwhelmed by sudden anger and fear in a heated debate. According to Plato, which part of the soul governs this?

A. Rational soul
B. Appetitive soul
C. Immortal soul
D. Spirited soul

Answer: D. Plato's spirited soul governs emotions. The rational soul is reason and intellect; the appetitive soul manages basic desires such as eating, drinking and sexual urges.

54. A man cannot resist eating and drinking excessively. Which part of Plato's soul is dominant?

A. Rational soul
B. Spirited soul
C. Ego
D. Appetitive soul

Answer: D. The appetitive soul manages basic desires such as eating, drinking and sexual urges.

55. A student believes humans were all-knowing before birth, forgot this when 'exiled' to earth, and can regain it through remembering, contemplation and doing good. Whose view is this?

A. Aristotle
B. Hume
C. Descartes
D. Plato

Answer: D. For Plato, man was omniscient before birth and can regain former perfection by remembering, contemplating and living virtuously, imitating the divine exemplar.

56. Aristotle says the soul is the form (functional organization) of the body and cannot be separated from it. What is this view called?

A. Hylomorphism
B. Dualism
C. Empiricism
D. Bundle theory

Answer: A. Aristotle's hylomorphism says a human is a composite of matter (body) and form (soul), the functional organization that allows life activities like growth, perception and thinking.

57. Debate: 'The true self is the soul and it is separable from the body.' Who held this, and who would disagree?

A. Aristotle held it; Plato disagreed
B. Hume held it; Locke disagreed
C. Kant held it; Descartes disagreed
D. Plato held it; Aristotle disagreed

Answer: D. Plato held that the true self is the soul (reason) and is separable from the body. Aristotle insisted the soul cannot be separated from the body.

58. Which philosophical view says that there is no innate knowledge and that knowledge comes from experience, with the self explained through sensory and bodily responses?

A. Rationalism
B. Empiricism
C. Idealism
D. Dualism

Answer: B. In empiricism, knowledge is derived from experience; the self is explained from sensory and bodily responses.

59. Which view reaches conclusions about the self through logic and reasoning rather than the senses or body, and holds that innate knowledge exists?

A. Rationalism
B. Empiricism
C. Behaviorism
D. Hedonism

Answer: A. Rationalism explains the self from the standpoint of the 'ideal' and the 'truth', not rooted in the senses or body; we arrive at conclusions through logic and reasoning.

60. A manager uses his employees only as tools to reach his private goals. Whose principle is violated?

A. Hume's bundle theory
B. Kant's principle that every person is an end in himself and should never be treated merely as a means
C. Locke's tabula rasa
D. Plato's three-part soul

Answer: B. Kant taught respect for the self: every man is an end in himself, a person should not be used as a tool or instrument, and all persons share the same basic rights.

Answer Key (Quick Check)

1. B **2.** C **3.** B **4.** C **5.** B **6.** A **7.** D **8.** B **9.** A **10.** C
11. C **12.** A **13.** C **14.** A **15.** D **16.** B **17.** C **18.** A **19.** B **20.** C
21. C **22.** C **23.** A **24.** B **25.** C **26.** C **27.** D **28.** A **29.** C **30.** B
31. B **32.** D **33.** B **34.** D **35.** B **36.** B **37.** A **38.** C **39.** A **40.** D
41. B **42.** D **43.** D **44.** A **45.** B **46.** A **47.** D **48.** D **49.** D **50.** A
51. C **52.** D **53.** D **54.** D **55.** D **56.** A **57.** D **58.** B **59.** A **60.** B